

Great Highland Pipe — Starter Songbook

Heifer Zephyr / Tony Koop, 2026 · 9-note A-mixolydian chanter (G4–A5)

At a glance

Range: low G (G4) — high A (A5). All 9 chanter notes used in every tune.

Key: A mixolydian (K:Amix) — written F# and C# throughout.

NO RESTS: phrase ends are held tones; the bag never stops sounding.

Ornaments: doublings, throw on D, grip, birl. The embellishments are the rhythm.

00-warmup-scales/

range-walk.abc ascending + descending across all 9 chanter notes (q=70)

intervals.abc 2nds, 3rds, 4ths, 5ths up the scale (q=72)

ornament-drill.abc one ornament family per line, 8x repeats (q=60)

01-easy/ (3 PD tunes)

scotland-the-brave AABA pipe-band march, q=90, melody only (PD; 1951 lyrics excluded)

loch-lomond Slow air, AB form, q=68, contour adapted to chanter

auld-lang-syne Through-form, q=80, transposed up a 3rd to A-mixolydian

02-intermediate/ (2 of the same melodies, denser ornaments)

loch-lomond-ornamented every long note doubled; throws on D; grips between B-c upbeats

auld-lang-syne-ornamented adds birls on repeated low A; doublings on every quarter

03-original/ (Heifer Zephyr commission)

drovers-path/ AABA slow march, q=76, all 9 chanter notes, MIT-licensed

Mood: dignified — drover walking cattle through highland mist

How to use

Each tune folder has tune.abc (canonical), tune.mid (playable), tune.musicxml (DAW-ready), tune-fingering.svg (per-note fingering), tune.pdf (one-page sheet), and notes.md (provenance, range checks, practice tips).

Suggested practice path: warmup -> easy tune -> add ornaments -> intermediate.
Save 03-original/drovers-path/ for when the easy set is solid.